

SOUL WORD ANALYSIS CARD

Framework B — Spirit, Soul and Body Research Programme

Phase 1 Individual Word Analysis

SECTION 1 — WORD IDENTITY

WORD	ABOMINATION
DATE ANALYSED	04/03/2026
REGISTRY NO.	1 of 181
SOURCE LIST	✓ Missing Inner Being Words
BIBLICAL PRESENCE	✓ Strong — multiple direct Hebrew and Greek terms exist
POLARITY	✓ Negative (with a secondary context-dependent dimension — see Section 8)

SECTION 2 — LINGUISTIC DATA

Hebrew Terms

Term	Transliteration	Gloss	Key References
■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■	toevah	abomination, detestable thing	Prov 6:16; Lev 18:22; Deu 7:25; Prov 12:22
■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■	sheqets	detestable / unclean thing	Lev 11:10–42; Isa 66:17; Eze 8:10
■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■	shiqquts	detestable idol / abomination	Deu 29:17; 1Ki 11:5,7; Dan 9:27; 11:31
■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■	miphletset	horror / abominable image	1Ki 15:13; 2Ch 15:16
■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■	piggul	tainted / ritually offensive thing	Lev 7:18–19; Eze 4:14
■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■	za'am	to be indignant, God's anger	Psa 7:11; Isa 66:14; Mic 6:10
■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■	ta'av	to abhor, regard as loathsome	Deu 23:7; Psa 106:40; Amos 5:10
■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■	shiqets	to detest, make detestable	Lev 11:11,43; Deu 7:26; Psa 22:24
■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■	ba'ash	to stink, become a stench	Exo 5:21; 2Sa 10:6; Psa 38:5

Greek Terms

Term	Transliteration	Gloss	Key References
βδ■ λυγμα	bdelugma	abomination	Luk 16:15; Rev 17:4,5; Matt 24:15; Rev 21:27
βδελυκτ■ς	bdeluktos	abominable (adjective)	Tit 1:16
βδελ■σσομαι	bdelussomai	to abhor, detest	Rom 2:22; Rev 21:8
■θ■μιτος	athemitos	unlawful, contrary to custom	Act 10:28; 1Pe 4:3

SECTION 3 — DIMENSION TAGS

Biblical / Theological	✓ Moral ✓ Covenantal ✓ Wisdom ✓ Prophetic ✓ Liturgical
Soul Faculty	✓ Moral-conscience ✓ Volitional ✓ Affective (disgust-response) ✓ Relational
Psychological	✓ Emotion (moral disgust) ✓ Motivation (avoidance) ✓ Self-concept (shame/identity) ✓ Regulation (boundary-setting)

Neurological	✓ Limbic (amygdala — threat/disgust) ✓ Prefrontal (moral reasoning) ✓ Autonomic (visceral disgust response) ✓ HPA-axis (sustained moral violation stress)
Physiological	✓ Cardiovascular (arousal) ✓ Endocrine (cortisol — moral stress) ✓ Muscular (recoil/withdrawal) ✓ Epigenetic (possible)
Social / Relational	✓ God-directed (divine response to human conduct) ✓ Other-directed (communal boundary enforcement) ✓ Self-directed (Eze 36:31 — self-loathing)

SECTION 4 — SEMANTIC RANGE

The English word 'abomination' flattens a rich and differentiated Hebrew vocabulary into a single register. The primary term **toevah** (טֹעֵוָה) is fundamentally relational — it describes something that is offensive or repulsive to a particular party, most often God. Its force is not primarily legal but evaluative: it names the divine reaction to certain human states, actions, and dispositions. The Proverbs usage is striking — **toevah** is applied not just to acts (lying, injustice, false weights) but to inner attitudes (arrogance of heart, Prov 16:5; crooked heart, Prov 11:20; wicked thoughts, Prov 15:26), making it a moral-conscience category at its core. **Sheqets** (שִׁקְצִים) and **shiqqs** (שִׁקְצִים) carry a stronger ritual-purity dimension, describing objects or creatures that defile by contact. **Ba'ash** (בִּאֵשׁ) adds the olfactory metaphor — stench — linking moral offence to physical revulsion. **Za'am** describes God's indignation as an aroused, sustained anger response. The Greek **bdelugma** carries the same relational-evaluative force as **toevah** and is used in Revelation for the systemic moral corruption of Babylon. Crucially, abomination is bidirectional in the text: it describes what God finds repulsive in humans, but also (Pro 29:27) what the righteous find repulsive in the wicked — and what the wicked find repulsive in the righteous. It is therefore a term that marks moral boundary, not just divine disapproval. The **athemitos** (ἄθεμιτος) usage in Acts 10:28 reveals a third dimension: culturally-constructed abomination, which God explicitly overrides — demonstrating that not all uses of the concept are theologically normative.

SECTION 5 — KEY VERSES

Eight verses selected to represent the full range of contexts and human dimensions.

VERSE 1	Proverbs 6:16–19
Text	"There are six things that the Lord hates, seven that are an abomination to him: haughty eyes, a lying tongue, and hands that shed innocent blood, a heart that devises wicked plans, feet that make haste to run to evil, a false witness who breathes out lies, and one who sows discord among brothers."
Context Type	✓ Wisdom ✓ Moral instruction
Human Impact	The enumerated list maps abomination directly onto inner dispositions (haughty eyes, heart that devises). The anatomy of abomination is revealed as beginning inside the person — in pride, intention, and imagination — before it reaches outward acts. This is a soul-anatomy text.
Direction	✓ Self-directed (inner dispositions) ✓ Other-directed (social harm)
Observation	Abomination originates in the inner being before manifesting in behaviour. The soul's orientation — its posture of pride and deceptive intent — is itself the source, not merely the acts that follow.

VERSE 2	Proverbs 16:5
Text	"Everyone who is arrogant in heart is an abomination to the Lord; be assured, he will not go unpunished."
Context Type	✓ Wisdom ✓ Individual-internal
Human Impact	A single inner disposition — arrogance of heart — is sufficient to constitute abomination. No external act is named. The heart-posture alone is the offence.
Direction	✓ Self-directed (inner state) ✓ God-directed (divine response)
Observation	This is the most condensed definition: abomination can be entirely internal. It locates the category within the soul's volitional and self-concept faculties — specifically the orientation of the heart toward self-exaltation.
VERSE 3	Luke 16:15
Text	"You are those who justify yourselves before men, but God knows your hearts. For what is exalted among men is an abomination in the sight of God."
Context Type	✓ Relational ✓ Individual-internal
Human Impact	Jesus identifies a gap between social reputation and God's evaluation of the inner state. What the human social world validates, God names abomination. The criterion shifts from external success to the hidden interior of the person.
Direction	✓ God-directed ✓ Other-directed (social performance)
Observation	The NT application redefines abomination from ritual category to heart-knowledge category. God's access to the heart is the operative claim — abomination is what God perceives in the hidden interior, not what humans perceive in public behaviour.
VERSE 4	Ezekiel 36:31
Text	"Then you will remember your evil ways, and your deeds that were not good, and you will loathe yourselves for your iniquities and your abominations."
Context Type	✓ Prophetic ✓ Covenantal ✓ Individual-internal
Human Impact	The renewed Israel will apply abomination to themselves — self-directed loathing as a result of Spirit-enabled moral clarity. This is the only clear instance of the term pointing inward in a redemptive frame.
Direction	✓ Self-directed ✓ Internally-generated
Observation	Regeneration produces the capacity for self-applied abomination — the soul's conscience, restored by the Spirit, now correctly evaluates its own past. This links abomination directly to the transformation vector in Framework B.

VERSE 5	Proverbs 12:22
Text	"Lying lips are an abomination to the Lord, but those who act faithfully are his delight."
Context Type	✓ Wisdom ✓ Moral instruction ✓ Relational
Human Impact	The antithetical parallelism is significant: abomination is paired with delight as polar opposites. Lying (inner disposition expressed in speech) stands against faithfulness (integrity of character). Abomination and delight are God's responses to two opposing soul-orientations.
Direction	✓ God-directed ✓ Other-directed
Observation	Abomination is not a standalone category — it exists on a spectrum with its opposite (delight). The soul that embodies abomination is antithetical to the soul characterised by faithfulness. This pairing is important for the polarity analysis across the 181 words.
VERSE 6	Jeremiah 6:15
Text	"Were they ashamed when they committed abomination? No, they were not at all ashamed; they did not know how to blush."
Context Type	✓ Prophetic ✓ Communal ✓ Moral failure
Human Impact	The absence of shame in the face of abomination is itself identified as catastrophic. The human capacity for shame — as a moral signal — has been disabled. The soul's conscience-feedback mechanism is broken.
Direction	✓ Communal ✓ Self-directed (absent response)
Observation	Abomination is connected here to the failure of shame as a moral regulator. The soul that cannot blush has lost a critical self-correcting faculty. This links abomination to neurological moral-emotion pathways (anterior insula, orbitofrontal cortex).
VERSE 7	Titus 1:16
Text	"They profess to know God, but they deny him by their works. They are detestable (bdeluktos), disobedient, unfit for any good work."
Context Type	✓ Relational ✓ Individual-internal ✓ Communal
Human Impact	The NT Greek bdeluktos describes a state of the person — not merely an act — where the profession of God-knowledge is contradicted by the condition of the soul. Abomination here is a category of spiritual inauthenticity and inner-outer contradiction.
Direction	✓ Self-directed ✓ God-directed ✓ Other-directed
Observation	The word moves from describing acts (OT primarily) to describing a state of the person (NT). The soul that is bdeluktos is characterised by internal contradiction — claimed identity versus actual condition.

VERSE 8	Proverbs 29:27
Text	"An unjust man is an abomination to the righteous, but one whose way is straight is an abomination to the wicked."
Context Type	✓ Wisdom ✓ Relational ✓ Moral polarity
Human Impact	Abomination is bidirectional: both poles of the moral spectrum find the other repulsive. The righteous soul and the wicked soul experience mutual abomination. This verse reveals that the disgust-response is a moral faculty operating in both directions — it is not exclusive to God.
Direction	✓ Other-directed ✓ Relational
Observation	Abomination is a moral-relational category embedded in the human soul, not only a divine response. The soul is equipped with a disgust-faculty that responds to moral violation — a faculty that operates in the righteous toward evil, and in the wicked toward righteousness. This is theologically and neurologically significant.

SECTION 6 — SOUL FUNCTION IN FRAMEWORK B

Soul Faculty Engaged	<i>Moral-conscience (primary) — the soul's capacity to evaluate actions, dispositions, and states as morally repulsive or acceptable. Secondary: Affective (disgust-response), Volitional (boundary-setting and avoidance), Relational (social and covenantal boundary marker).</i>
Framework B Contribution	<i>Abomination reveals that the soul possesses an evaluative-disgust faculty — a moral sensing mechanism that registers violation, that operates both inward (self-evaluation) and outward (response to others), and that is intimately connected to the divine moral register. This faculty is absent from nephesh/psych taxonomy alone.</i>
Regenerate Expression	<i>The Spirit-transformed soul applies abomination correctly: to its own past (Eze 36:31), to injustice and deception, to the exaltation of self (Luk 16:15). It retains the disgust faculty but it is now calibrated to God's moral register rather than social convention or personal preference.</i>
Unregenerate Expression	<i>The corrupt soul either (a) loses the capacity for moral disgust altogether — it cannot blush (Jer 6:15) — or (b) redirects it: finding righteousness abominable (Pro 29:27). The faculty remains but is inverted, detecting abomination in goodness rather than in evil.</i>

SECTION 7 — NEUROSCIENCE & PSYCHOLOGY

Brain Regions / Systems	<i>Moral disgust is processed primarily in the anterior insula (visceral disgust signal), anterior cingulate cortex (conflict monitoring, moral violation detection), and orbitofrontal cortex (moral evaluation and social norm processing). The amygdala mediates the threat-response dimension of abomination. Research: Moll et al. (2002, Neuron) demonstrated that moral disgust activates medial orbitofrontal cortex distinctly from basic disgust. Haidt's moral foundations research identifies disgust as a primary moral intuition system (The Righteous Mind, 2012).</i>
Physiological Markers	<i>Disgust response: nausea, lip-curl, narrowing of nasal passages, elevated heart rate, skin conductance response (galvanic). Moral disgust produces similar but distinct autonomic signature to physical disgust (Chapman & Anderson, 2012). Sustained moral stress activates HPA-axis — elevated cortisol, immune modulation. The ba'ash stench metaphor in the text is consistent with the olfactory-disgust neural pathway (piriform cortex) being recruited for moral evaluation.</i>

Psychological Framework	<i>Moral Foundations Theory (Haidt) — sanctity/degradation foundation. Terror Management Theory — mortality salience and boundary maintenance. Cognitive-behavioural: avoidance conditioning. Object relations: internal representations of the 'bad object'. Developmental: shame as a socialising mechanism (Lewis, 1992). The Jer 6:15 loss-of-shame pattern maps to alexithymia (impaired emotional recognition) and psychopathic moral indifference.</i>
Behavioural Signature	<i>Avoidance and withdrawal from the abominable object/person/act. Social exclusion and boundary enforcement (cut off from the people). Prophetic confrontation (Ezekiel's repeated commissioning). Self-distancing (Eze 36:31 — memory-triggered aversion to one's own past). When the faculty is inverted (Jer 6:15): continued engagement with the abominable without aversion, normalisation of moral violation.</i>
Epigenetic Potential	<i>✓ Possible — Sustained moral-stress activation of HPA-axis is documented as epigenetically transmissible (cortisol regulation genes — NR3C1 methylation; Meaney, 2010). The communal and generational pattern in Ezekiel (fathers' abominations transmitted to children) is consistent with epigenetic inheritance of stress-dysregulation. Confidence: Moderate.</i>
Confidence Level	<i>✓ High for moral disgust neuroscience (well-established). ✓ Moderate for epigenetic dimension (evidence exists, direct link to this construct requires caution).</i>

SECTION 8 — BIBLICAL vs MODERN PSYCHOLOGY

Biblical Grounding	<i>✓ Direct word exists — multiple Hebrew and Greek terms cover the semantic range with precision.</i>
Modern Construct Gap	<i>Modern psychology does not use the term "abomination." The nearest constructs are: moral disgust (Haidt), moral injury (Litz et al., 2009 — violation of deeply held moral beliefs), and moral disengagement (Bandura). None carry the covenantal-relational dimension of <i>toevah</i> — the idea that certain inner states are inherently offensive to the divine Person. Psychology treats moral disgust as an evolved social emotion; scripture treats abomination as an objective moral category with a divine referent. The gap is theological: the referent is God, not social consensus.</i>
Convergence Points	<i>Both traditions agree that (1) moral disgust is a real psychological faculty with neurological basis; (2) loss of this faculty (inability to blush, Jer 6:15) represents moral pathology; (3) the faculty can be misdirected (Pro 29:27 — finding righteousness repulsive) consistent with moral disengagement theory; (4) the faculty begins in internal states, not only external acts.</i>
Divergence Points	<i>Psychology grounds abomination in evolutionary social function (group boundary maintenance). Scripture grounds it in the character of God and the objective moral order. Psychology does not recognise self-applied abomination as redemptive (Eze 36:31); it would typically treat it as pathological self-condemnation. Scripture treats it as a sign of restoration. This is a significant theological divergence with direct clinical implications.</i>

SECTION 9 — RELATED WORDS (from the 181)

Intensifies / Generates	<i>Anger (4) — divine wrath as the response to accumulating abomination; Shame (146) — the appropriate internal response to recognised abomination; Guilt (73) — the judicial dimension; Condemnation (24) — the verdict dimension; Corruption (31) — the state that abomination produces over time; Wickedness (172) — the broad category of which abomination is the most acute form.</i>
Opposes / Resolves	<i>Holiness (76) — the antithesis of abomination in God's character; Purity (125) — the state from which abomination departs; Repentance (135) — the process that addresses abomination; Blamelessness (14) — the character that God finds delightful (antithetical parallelism in Proverbs).</i>
Co-occurs With	<i>Idolatry (83) — the most frequent co-occurrence in prophetic literature; Whoredom (171) — linked in Ezekiel's extended metaphor; Defilement (41) — the state abomination produces; Iniquity (89) — often paired; Pride (123) — arrogance of heart as abomination (Prov 16:5).</i>

Registry Numbers

4 (anger), 14 (blamelessness), 24 (condemnation), 31 (corruption), 41 (defilement), 73 (guilt), 76 (holiness), 83 (idolatry), 89 (iniquity), 123 (pride), 125 (purity), 135 (repentance), 146 (shame), 171 (whoredom), 172 (wickedness)

SECTION 10 — OPEN QUESTIONS & FLAGS

1. BIDIRECTIONALITY FLAG: Pro 29:27 raises an under-explored dimension — the righteous soul's abomination-response to evil is the mirror image of God's response. This suggests abomination is not only a divine attribute but a faculty imparted to the image-bearing soul. This has significant implications for the soul anatomy in Framework B and warrants a dedicated exegetical note. 2. SHAME LINKAGE: The Jer 6:15 / Jer 8:12 pattern (loss of capacity to blush) needs to be cross-analysed with the shame (146) card when complete. The two words appear to be reciprocally dependent: where abomination-faculty fails, shame-faculty also fails. 3. ATHEMITOS ANOMALY: The Acts 10:28 usage (Peter's vision) demonstrates that some categories of abomination are culturally constructed rather than morally absolute. This requires careful handling in Framework B — not all toevah/bdelugma usage carries equal theological weight. 4. PHASE 2 FLAG — POLARITY ANALYSIS: Abomination is strongly negative in primary usage but contains a redemptive secondary valence (Eze 36:31). Flag for the dual-valence cross-analysis in Phase 2. 5. PHASE 2 FLAG — NEUROLOGICAL SET: Strong candidate for inclusion in the neurological/physiological cross-analysis given the well-documented moral disgust neuroscience and the olfactory metaphor (ba'ash).